BUYER'S *Guide*



CHRIS ZENONE

OAKWYN REALTY

778-883-1594
chriszenone@outlook.com

Welcome

This is your comprehensive Real Estate Buyer's Guide. As your dedicated REALTOR®, I'm here to guide you through one of the most significant decisions of your life — finding and purchasing your home. With years of experience in the Vancouver market and a deep understanding of what homebuyers truly need, my commitment to you is unwavering. I believe everyone deserves a place to call their own, and it's my mission to make that happen for you — with honesty, expertise, and care every step of the way.

-Chris Zenone

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

Chriszenone@outlook.com



CHRIS ZENONE

REAL ESTATE AGENT

Chris Zenone, your dynamic Realtor® ready to elevate your real estate experience! Specializing in uncovering dream homes and mastering negotiations for optimal outcomes, I'm here to guide you through a seamless and prosperous journey in real estate. Together, let's turn the key to your next chapter and unlock the door to your future home!

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

TESTIMONIALS

Beyond grateful to have been able to work with a realtor as dedicated and personable as Chris. He went above and beyond to find me a pre-sale that fit all my needs and did so with care. Thank you Chris!

Chris was great! He helped us find a two bedroom condo in Vancouver and we are very happy with what we found together, he was patient with us, kind and detail oriented!

Chris is incredibly knowledgeable at both the market and property in general. While remaining respectful and professional, his kind and charismatic approach creates a warm, trustworthy and welcoming environment.

I would recommend his services to anyone as they prepare to enter the market or find their forever home.

I loved having Chris as our realtor. Not only did he help facilitate the sale of our existing home, but he helped us find the perfect home for our growing family. We now recommend him to all of our friends and family!

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

WHY USE A REALTOR®

Access to Comprehensive Listings:
As a licensed REALTOR®, I have access to the full MLS® system — including listings not yet publicly marketed. You won't miss a property that meets your criteria.

Expert Negotiation Skills:
Negotiating a real estate purchase involves far more than price. I negotiate subjects, dates, inclusions, and terms firmly and strategically to get you the best possible outcome.

In-depth Market Knowledge:
I specialize in East Vancouver and surrounding neighbourhoods. I know the streets, the buildings, and the price trends, so you make smarter, more informed decisions

Handling of Paperwork and Legalities:
Real estate transactions involve contracts, disclosure forms, title searches, and strict deadlines. I handle every detail meticulously so your interests are always protected.



CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

THE BUYING JOURNEY

FINANCIAL PREPARATION:

1

- Assess your finances to determine your budget.
- Get pre-approved for a mortgage to understand your buying power.

DEFINE YOUR HOME WISHLIST:

2

- List out your must-haves, nice-to-haves, and deal-breakers.
- Consider location, size, type of home, and other important features.

Consultation

3

- Help me understand your needs, then enter into an agency relationship
- I will guide you through the buying process and offer valuable insights.

SEARCH FOR HOMES:

4

- Explore listings online and visit open houses.
- Your Realtor® will arrange private showings of homes that match your criteria.

MAKE AN OFFER:

5

- I will help you make a competitive offer.
- Be prepared for negotiations on price, conditions, and dates.

Due Diligence

6

- Inspection
- Title Search
- Property Disclosure
- Review Strata Documents
- Form B
- Strata Minutes
- Financial Statements

CLOSE THE DEAL:

7

- Finalize your mortgage details and prepare for closing costs.
- Sign the paperwork to transfer ownership, and receive the keys to your new home.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

1 FINANCIAL PREPARATION

ASSESS YOUR FINANCES

Begin your home-buying journey by taking a comprehensive look at your current financial situation. This involves tallying up your income, savings, existing debts, and regular expenses. A key guideline is to ensure your future monthly housing payment (including mortgage, property taxes, and insurance) doesn't exceed 28-31% of your gross monthly income. Remember, it's also important to factor in potential costs for maintenance and utilities to avoid any surprises.

GET PRE-APPROVED

A mortgage pre-approval is a crucial step that will give you a clear understanding of how much you can afford to spend on a new home. It involves a lender reviewing your financial background—like your income, credit history, and debt levels—to determine how much they're willing to lend you and at what interest rate. Having a pre-approval letter in hand not only clarifies your budget but also signals to sellers that you are a serious and capable buyer, potentially making your offer more attractive.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

2 DEFINE YOUR WISHLIST

LIST OUT YOUR MUST-HAVES, NICE-TO-HAVES, AND DEAL-BREAKERS

- Must-Haves: These are non-negotiable features your new home must have for you to consider it. This could include the number of bedrooms, accessibility features, or specific school districts.
- Nice-to-Haves: Features you'd love to have but aren't deal-breakers. Examples might include a swimming pool, an office space, or a large backyard.
- Deal-Breakers: Aspects of a property that would immediately take it off your list. Common deal-breakers include being located on a busy street, lacking a garage, or requiring extensive renovations.

CONSIDER LOCATION, SIZE, TYPE OF HOME, AND OTHER FEATURES

- Location: Think about the ideal area for your new home. Do you prefer the heart of the city, a suburban neighborhood, or a quiet rural area? Consider proximity to work, schools, amenities, and public transport.
- Size: Determine the size of the home you need, considering your current and future lifestyle. How many beds and baths? Do you need extra space for hobbies or guests?
- Type of Home: Are you looking for a single-family home, a condo, a townhouse, or perhaps a duplex? Each type of home offers different advantages and lifestyles.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

3 CONSULTATION

A dedicated opportunity to understand your needs, address your concerns, and craft a tailored plan of action. It's about actively listening, offering valuable insights, and collaborating closely to achieve your goals. In essence, consultation is the foundation of our partnership, where we work together to pave the path towards success.





4 SEARCH FOR HOMES

Begin your home search with your Realtor® guiding the way. Start online to explore listings and virtual tours to identify potential homes. Attend open houses to get a feel for different properties and neighborhoods. Your Realtor® will also arrange private showings, allowing you to thoroughly inspect homes that meet your criteria and envision your life in them.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com



5 MAKE AN OFFER

Finding the right home sparks a mix of excitement and anticipation. It's time to make it yours. Crafting a competitive offer is where your Realtor®'s expertise becomes invaluable. They will guide you through the process, ensuring your offer is attractive yet fair, considering the market conditions and the specifics of the property.

- **Crafting Your Offer:** Your Realtor® will advise you on the offer's components, including the price, contingencies (like financing and inspection), and any personal touches to make your offer stand out.
- **Negotiation Phase:** Be prepared for negotiations. Sellers may counter your offer, leading to discussions about the price, conditions, closing dates, or even what's included in the sale. Your Realtor® will negotiate on your behalf, aiming to reach an agreement that meets your needs and expectations.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

6 DUE DILIGENCE

Before finalizing the purchase, few crucial steps ensure you're making a sound investment: the home inspection and reviewing Strata Documents.

HOME INSPECTION:

A thorough home inspection conducted by a professional is essential to uncover any hidden issues with the property. From the foundation to the roof, plumbing to electrical systems, this step can save you from future surprises and expenses. Depending on the findings, you may renegotiate the deal, request repairs, or sometimes, decide to walk away.

STRATA DOCUMENTS:

I ensure you receive comprehensive insight into the property's management, financial health, and regulations. Offering clarity on aspects like bylaws, financial statements, meeting minutes, and maintenance schedules. Reviewing these documents, we'll have a thorough understanding of the property's status, empowering you to make informed decisions with confidence.
These steps are about safeguarding your investment, and providing peace of mind as you proceed with the purchase.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone
Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594
Chriszenone@outlook.com

7 CLOSE THE DEAL

The final step in your home-buying journey is closing the deal. This phase involves finalizing your mortgage details, preparing for closing costs (such as property transfer tax, legal fees, and title insurance), and reviewing your statement of adjustments.

FINALIZING MORTGAGE DETAILS:

- Work with your lender to ensure all financing is in order, understanding the terms and conditions of your mortgage.

CLOSING COSTS:

- Be prepared for closing costs, which typically range from 2% to 5% of the home's purchase price. Your lawyer or notary will prepare a statement of adjustments listing these costs.

Signing Day: The day you've been waiting for. You'll sign the paperwork to officially transfer ownership of the home to you. Once everything is signed, sealed, and delivered, you'll receive the keys to your new home.



CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone

Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

Moving Checklist

8 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Take Inventory of belongings and keep, sell, or toss
- [ ] Research Moving companies and book
- [ ] Organize all moving-related documents and checklists

6 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Buy moving boxes, tape, and packing materials
- [ ] Pack items you rarely use
- [ ] Notify Schools and Employers of your move

4 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] File a change with the post office, banks, etc
- [ ] Schedule utilities for disconnection and connection
- [ ] Transfer records and prescriptions

3 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Pack and label boxes by room and contents
- [ ] Plan for the transport of pets and plants
- [ ] Use up perishable food items

2 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Verify details with the moving company
- [ ] Pack an essentials box for the first few days
- [ ] Pack important docs and valuables to move personally

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone
Oakwyn Realty HQ

778-883-1594
chriszenone@outlook.com

FAQ

PROPERTY TRANSFER TAX

Property Transfer Tax (PTT) is a provincial tax paid by buyers when a property changes hands. Unless you qualify for the First Time Home Buyers Program (see below), you will be required to pay PTT at the completion of your purchase.
PTT rates are as follows:

First $200,000: 1.0%
$200,001 - $2,000,000: 2.0%
$2,000,001 - $3,000,000: 3.0%
Over $3,000,000: 3.0% plus an additional 2.0% on the residential portion

First-Time Home Buyers' Program:
No PTT is charged on the first $500,000 of the purchase price for homes valued up to $835,000, a saving of up to $8,000. A partial exemption applies to homes valued between $835,000 and $860,000. To qualify:
a) You are a Canadian citizen or permanent resident.
b) You have lived in BC for 12 consecutive months before buying, or filed 2 BC income tax returns in the last 6 years.
c) You have never owned a principal residence anywhere in the world.
d) The property will be your principal residence.

Newly Built Home Exemption

The newly built home exemption reduces or eliminates the property transfer tax on qualifying purchases of a principal residence.

Full exemption: Effective April 1, 2024, the fair market value threshold for a full exemption for newly built homes is increased from $750,000 to $1,100,000.

Partial exemption: A partial exemption is also available for properties with fair market values just above the threshold. The phase out range is $50,000 above the threshold, with the complete elimination of the exemption at $1,150,000 for qualifying purchasers.

DOWN PAYMENT

Your down payment is a crucial component of your home purchase. Depending on the lender and the property type, down payments can vary. As a general rule, for condos, townhouses, or detached houses, the minimum down payment is 5% of the first $500,000 and 10% of the portion between $500,000 and $1.5 million. Homes priced at $1.5 million or more require at least 20% down, and bare land purchases usually require at least 50%. If your down payment is less than 20%, you'll need mortgage default insurance (through CMHC or a private insurer). Premiums range from 2.80% to 4.00% of the loan amount depending on your down payment, plus 0.20% if you choose a 30-year amortization, which first-time buyers are eligible for.

OTHER COSTS

In addition to the above expenses, here are some other costs to consider:

1.House Inspection: It's highly recommended to have a thorough inspection of the property before finalizing the purchase. Inspection costs typically range from $300 to $600.

2.Lawyers Fees: Legal representation is crucial in the real estate transaction process. Expect to pay between $1000 to $1200 for legal fees.

3.GST (Goods and Services Tax): If you're purchasing a new development, you may be subject to GST on the purchase price.

CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone
Oakwyn Realty HQ


778-883-1594


chriszenone@outlook.com



CHRIS ZENONE

Chris Zenone
Oakwyn Realty HQ
778-883-1594
chriszenone@outlook.com



Chris Zenone

778-883-1594

chriszenone@outlook.com

CHRIS ZENONE

OAKWYN REALTY